I stand divided,

torn between your eyes;

for through their obsidian

gleam, I see me.

Me, in pieces—

splintered, splayed and held in place

by sticky, silver needlepoint-frill;

limp but stuck—

and I wonder why I bother,

knowing that my intent

and my actions

won't bridge those gaps?

Maybe there's a thread keeping me up—

a deeper truth to unravel

from this web you've tangled to a mess inside me.

And maybe that thread is where the scream comes from?—

the scream haunting my ears,

trailing my steps,

shuttering my eyes,

then gifting me nothing but

phantom tear tracks.

Maybe

I search, and I strive, to remind myself

that the spider has its foothold somewhere

deep inside, and from there the scream echoes;

and that means I can hunt them *within* me. They are *not* me.

I exist outside,

around, the spider

and the scream.

And I **shall** exist

freely.